

Fourth Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Quarta Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: Christ's word orders a groaning world and a rebellious will

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Dominus illuminatio mea</i> (Ps. 26:1–3)	Light, salvation, courage	God's light does not deny conflict; it gives the endangered worshipper courage to enter it faithfully.
Collect	<i>Da nobis, quaesumus, Domine</i>	Providence, peace, devotion	The Church asks that the world's course be peacefully ordered and her own devotion made tranquil.
Epistle	Rom. 8:18–23	Creation's groaning and bodily glory	Present suffering belongs to a creation awaiting incorruption and the redemption of the body.
Gradual	<i>Propitius esto, Domine, peccatis nostris</i> (Ps. 78:9–10)	Forgiveness and deliverance	Before apostolic fruit, the Church confesses need and refuses to make results her own vindication.
Alleluia	<i>Deus, qui sedes super thronum</i> (Ps. 9:5, 10)	Judgment and refuge	The Judge enthroned above the sea interprets depth and failure under divine justice and refuge.
Gospel	Luke 5:1–11	Christ's word, the catch, vocation	Teaching precedes mission; abundance follows Christ's command and brings Peter to confession and vocation.
Offertory	<i>Illumina oculos meos</i> (Ps. 12:4–5)	Illumination against death	The offering asks for eyes kept awake when exhaustion and apparent futility invite surrender.
Communion	<i>Dominus firmamentum meum</i> (Ps. 17:3)	Refuge and deliverance	The one sent into the deep receives God himself as strength, refuge, and deliverer.
Postcommunion	<i>Mysteria nos, Domine, sumpta purificent</i>	Purification and protection	Mission ends neither in technique nor visible success: the mysteries purify and guard the laborer.

Sense	Synthesis
Literal	Luke narrates Jesus teaching from Simon's boat, commanding a new cast after an empty night, granting a catch that strains nets and boats, and calling Peter to catch men; Romans describes creation and believers groaning for bodily redemption.
Allegorical	Augustine reads the first catch as the Church in her present, mixed condition. The boat bears Christ's teaching, and the net gathers people through the apostolic mission his word initiates.
Moral	The disciple submits discouragement and even a rebellious will to Christ's efficacious word, obeys after failure, confesses sin when grace bears fruit, and follows rather than claiming the catch.
Anagogical	Chrysostom reads creation's groaning as desire for incorruption and the body's perfect glory; Augustine contrasts the present mixed catch with the final shore and resurrection.

World, Church, and Will Under the Word

Reading key

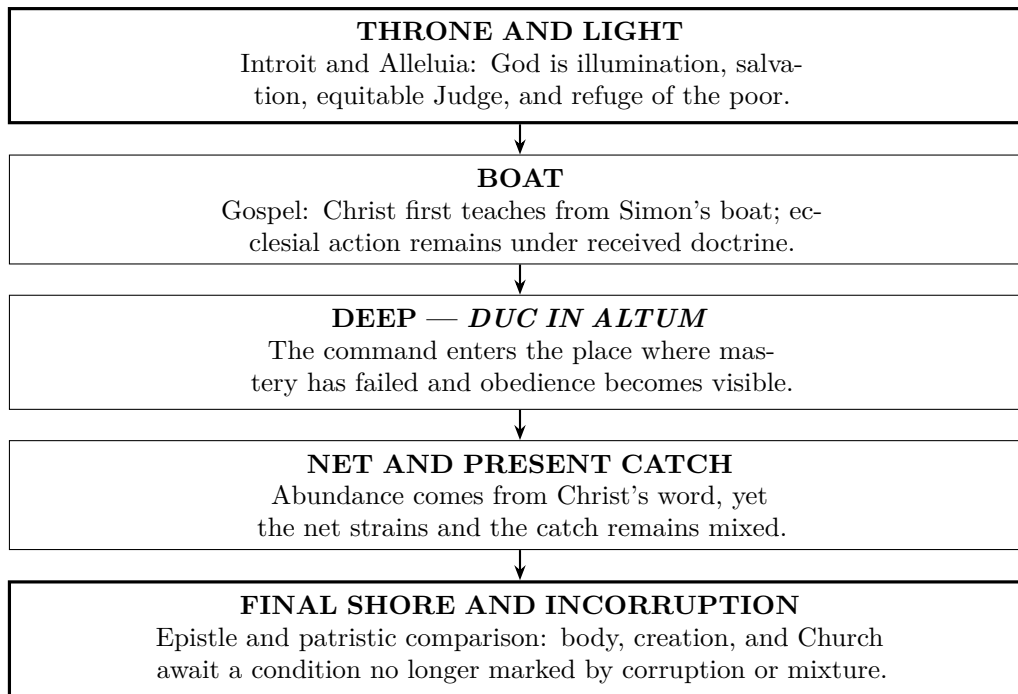
The propers move across three nested scales without changing their center. Creation groans for bodily redemption; the Church labors through an empty night and a burdened catch; the individual brings darkened sight and a rebellious will. At every scale, order is received from God’s providence and Christ’s efficacious word rather than manufactured from below.

Three Scales of Disorder and Restoration

Scale	Disorder experienced	Divine ordering	Promised form
Creation and body	Present suffering, corruption, travail, and the still-unredeemed body (Rom. 8:18–23)	The Collect places the course of the world under God’s peaceful direction; the Epistle interprets travail as expectant rather than terminal.	Freedom from corruption, adoption made manifest, and bodily glory.
Church and mission	An empty night, breaking nets, sinking boats, and a catch not yet sorted	Christ teaches from the boat, commands the cast, gives the catch, removes fear, and gives vocation.	A Church gathered by the word and awaiting the final shore rather than claiming present purity.
Person and will	Fear, consciousness of sin, exhausted perception, and resistance to God’s command	The Introit names God as light; the Offertory asks illuminated eyes; the Secret asks that rebellious wills be mercifully compelled toward God.	Obedience strengthened by God as refuge, then purified and guarded by the mysteries.

The size of Christian redemption
Commenting on Romans 8, St. John Chrysostom writes: “For this is full redemption, not a redemption only, but such, that we shall never again return to our former captivity.” Christian hope is bodily and cosmic: corruption is overcome, not declared irrelevant.

The Vertical Geography of the Sunday



Editorial map. Luke's appointed scene does not narrate a final shore. That horizon comes from Romans 8 and Augustine's comparison of Luke 5 with the eschatological catch in John 21. The Alleluia's throne, likewise, supplies a theological vantage over the Gospel's depth rather than a location within the narrative.

The Gospel as Word, Response, and Effect

Moment	Kind of act	What changes
Christ teaches from the boat	Public instruction	The boat becomes a place governed by Christ's doctrine before it becomes an instrument of gathering.
Christ says, <i>Duc in altum</i> , and commands the nets	Imperative	Failed expertise is not denied, but it ceases to be the final authority.
Simon answers, "at thy word"	Obedient response containing an honest objection	Consent is possible before the result is visible and without pretending the night was fruitful.
The catch fills and strains the nets	Efficacious gift	The word produces what technique could not; partners are summoned because the gift exceeds private capacity.
Peter confesses his sinfulness	Recognition	Abundance discloses the holiness of the giver and the recipient's unworthiness.
Christ says, "Fear not"	Reassurance	Confession is answered neither by denial of sin nor by cancellation of relationship.

Moment	Kind of act	What changes
Christ says that Peter will catch men	Vocation and promise	A failed fisherman becomes a servant of a gathering whose efficacy remains Christ's.

The Secret: The Will Placed Under the Word

Et ad te nostras etiam rebelles compelle propitius voluntates

- *ad te* — grace has a personal direction: toward God, not merely toward improved results.
- *nostras . . . voluntates* — what is brought to sacrifice includes “our wills,” not only gifts, fatigue, or circumstances.
- *etiam rebelles* — the prayer names the will even in its resistant condition; rebellion is neither concealed nor treated as immovable.
- *compelle propitius* — “mercifully compel” holds efficacy and mercy together. The Church asks God to do more than advise a will left sufficient to itself.

The Secret is therefore the interior counterpart to the Gospel: the word that fills the net is asked to move the person who still resists being drawn toward God.

The Word's Course Through the Mass

Phase	Propers	Interpretive work
Orientation	Introit + Collect	Divine light supplies courage amid conflict, while providence places both the world's course and the Church's devotion under peaceful order.
Expectation	Epistle + Gradual + Alleluia	Cosmic groaning is joined to confession and mercy; the enthroned Judge becomes refuge, so hope is neither self-vindication nor optimism about visible results.
Disclosure	Gospel	Christ's teaching, command, gift, reception of confession, and vocation reveal how the divine word establishes ecclesial fruit.
Interior offering	Offertory + Secret	Darkened eyes ask illumination, and rebellious wills are placed under God's mercifully efficacious action. The laborer offers perception and will before achievement.
Sacramental stability	Communion + Postcommunion	God himself is received as strength, refuge, liberator, and helper; the mysteries purify and protect the person whom the word continues to send.

At Mass: listen on three scales

The Introit and Offertory concern perception; the Collect and Epistle concern the world's order and destiny; the Gospel concerns the Church's gathering; the Secret concerns the will's resistance; Communion and Postcommunion concern the sacramental stability of the person within the larger work. No scale is healed in isolation from the others.

What the Catch Means—and Does Not Mean

Feature	It supports	It does not prove	Interpretive guardrail
Abundant catch	The efficacy and gratuity of Christ's word	That visible scale is a sufficient measure of holiness or fidelity	Gift leads Peter to confession, not self-congratulation.
Straining nets and boats	The burden and mixed condition of the Church in the present age	That Christ's word has failed	The partners share the labor while the Church awaits final purification.
Summoned partners	Ecclesial cooperation and distributed responsibility	A solitary model of spiritual mastery	The catch exceeds Simon's private capacity and remains Christ's gift.
Peter's confession	A true encounter with holiness and sin	That acknowledged unworthiness cancels vocation	Christ answers confession with "Fear not" and a call.
Bodily redemption	Renewal of embodied persons and creation beyond corruption	Escape from matter or indifference to present suffering	Romans' travail is ordered toward glory, not toward the abandonment of creation.

Augustine's ecclesial control

St. Augustine, *Tractates on the Gospel of John* 122.7: "The capture of fishes signified the good and bad presently existing in the Church." The catch can signify true gathering without making abundance evidence that the present Church is already unmixed.

Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* (1962), *Dominica Quarta post Pentecosten*; local OCR temporal corpus. Its Gospel heading reads *Luc. 6, 1–11*, an unresolved OCR error; the pericope itself is Luke 5:1–11.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homilies on Romans*, Homily 14, comments on Rom. 8:18–23, NPNF working English translation.
- St. Augustine, *Tractates on the Gospel of John*, Tractate 122.7, comparison of Luke 5 and John 21, NPNF working English translation.